

// REFERENCE SHEET

HTML, one tag at a time.

Every commonly used tag in plain, one-line language — the code on the left, the actual rendered result on the right. What you see in the output panel is real HTML rendering in your browser, not a description of it.

Code — what you type

Output — what the browser shows

[01 Page Structure](#)[02 Text & Headings](#)[03 Links & Media](#)[04 Lists](#)[05 Tables](#)[06 Forms & Inputs](#)[07 Layout & Semantics](#)[08 Interactive Extras](#)[09 Comments](#)

01 Page Structure

The skeleton every HTML page is built on. Most of these have no visible output — they set up the page.

<!DOCTYPE html>

Use to start every HTML5 page

INDEX.HTML

<!DOCTYPE html>



PREVIEW

No visual output – sets the browser's rendering mode.

`<title>` Use to set the browser tab text

INDEX.HTML

```
<title>My First Page</title>
```



TAB PREVIEW



My First Page

`<meta>` Use to add page info like charset for browsers

INDEX.HTML

```
<meta charset="UTF-8">
```



PREVIEW

No visual output – used by the browser and search engines.

`<link>` Use to load an external CSS file

INDEX.HTML

```
<link rel="stylesheet" href="style.css">
```



PREVIEW

No visual output itself – it loads the styles that change the look.

`<style>` Use to write CSS inside the page

INDEX.HTML

```
<style>
  p { color: crimson; }
</style>
```



PREVIEW

This paragraph turns red.

<script>

Use to add JavaScript to the page

INDEX.HTML

```
<script>
  alert("Hi");
</script>
```



PREVIEW

□ Popup dialog appears: "Hi"

<body>

Use to hold all visible page content

INDEX.HTML

```
<body>Hello World</body>
```



PREVIEW

Hello World

02 Text & Headings

The tags you'll use in almost every paragraph you write.

<h1>...<h6>

Use for section headings, biggest to smallest

INDEX.HTML

```
<h1>Big Heading</h1>
<h6>Small Heading</h6>
```



PREVIEW

Big Heading

Small Heading

```
<p>
```

Use for a paragraph of text

INDEX.HTML

```
<p>This is a paragraph.</p>
```



PREVIEW

This is a paragraph.

```
<br>
```

Use to force a line break

INDEX.HTML

```
Line one<br>Line two
```



PREVIEW

Line one
Line two

```
<hr>
```

Use to divide content with a line

INDEX.HTML

```
Above<hr>Below
```



PREVIEW

Above

Below

`<b> / <strong>`

Use to make text bold

INDEX.HTML

`<b>Bold</b>` and `<strong>Important</strong>`



PREVIEW

Bold and Important

`<i> / <em>`

Use to make text italic

INDEX.HTML

`<i>Italic</i>` and `<em>Emphasized</em>`



PREVIEW

Italic and Emphasized

`<small>`

Use to shrink text, like fine print

INDEX.HTML

Regular `<small>fine print</small>`



PREVIEW

Regularfine print

`<mark>`

Use to highlight text

INDEX.HTML

This is `<mark>important</mark>`



PREVIEW

This isimportant

<sub> / <sup>

Use for chemical formulas or exponents

INDEX.HTML

H₂O and x²



PREVIEW

H2O and x2

** / <ins>**

Use to show edited text — removed or added

INDEX.HTML

\$40 <ins>\$25</ins>



PREVIEW

~~\$40~~ \$25

<blockquote>

Use for a quoted passage

INDEX.HTML

<blockquote>Stay hungry.</blockquote>



PREVIEW

Stay hungry.

<code> / <pre>

Use to show a snippet of code

INDEX.HTML

```
<code>let x = 5;</code>
```



PREVIEW

```
let x = 5;
```

<abbr>

Use for an abbreviation with a hover meaning

INDEX.HTML

```
<abbr title="HyperText Markup Language">HTML</abbr>
```



PREVIEW

HTML (hover to see meaning)

<address>

Use for contact or location details

INDEX.HTML

```
<address>Patna, India</address>
```



PREVIEW

Patna, India

03 Links & Media

Getting the page to point at other places and other files.

<a>

Use to link to another page

INDEX.HTML

```
<a href="https://google.com">Go to Google</a>
```



PREVIEW

[Go to Google](#)

Use to show an image

INDEX.HTML

```

```



PREVIEW



<figure> / <figcaption>

Use to pair an image with a caption



Parent → Child: `<figure>` wraps the image and its caption together as one unit. The `<figcaption>` inside it is the caption text shown below (or above) the image.

INDEX.HTML

```
<figure>
  
  <figcaption>A cat</figcaption>
</figure>
```



PREVIEW



A cat

<video>

Use to play a video

INDEX.HTML


```
<video src="movie.mp4" controls></video>
```



PREVIEW



movie.mp4

<audio>

Use to play audio

INDEX.HTML

```
<audio src="song.mp3" controls></audio>
```



PREVIEW



0:42

<iframe>

Use to embed another webpage

INDEX.HTML

```
<iframe src="https://example.com"></iframe>
```



PREVIEW

example.com loaded here

04 Lists

Bullet points, numbered steps, and term/definition pairs.

 /

Use for a bullet-point list



Parent → Child: holds the whole list. Each bullet is its own tag nested inside — add as many as you have items.

INDEX.HTML

```
<ul>
  <li>Tea</li>
  <li>Coffee</li>
  <li>Milk</li>
</ul>
```



PREVIEW

- Tea
- Coffee
- Milk

`<ol> / <li>`

Use for a numbered list

 **Parent → Child:** Same idea as `<ul>`, but the browser numbers the items automatically (1, 2, 3...) instead of using bullets. You still write each step as its own `<li>`.

INDEX.HTML

```
<ol>
  <li>Wake up</li>
  <li>Eat</li>
  <li>Go to work</li>
</ol>
```



PREVIEW

1. Wake up
2. Eat
3. Go to work

`<dl> / <dt> / <dd>`

Use for a glossary of terms

 **Parent → Child:** `<dl>` wraps the whole glossary. Each entry is a pair: `<dt>` holds the term, and the `<dd>` right after it holds that term's definition. Repeat the pair for each word.

INDEX.HTML

```
<dl>
  <dt>HTML</dt>
  <dd>A markup language</dd>
  <dt>CSS</dt>
```

```
<dd>A styling language</dd>
</dl>
```



PREVIEW

HTML

A markup language

CSS

A styling language

05 Tables

Rows and columns for structured data.

```
<table> <tr> <th> <td>
```

Use to show data in rows and columns



Parent → Child → Grandchild: `<table>` holds every `<tr>` (table row). Inside each `<tr>` go the cells: `<th>` for a bold header cell, `<td>` for a normal data cell. One `<tr>` = one horizontal line of the table.

INDEX.HTML

```
<table>
  <tr>
    <th>Name</th>
    <th>Age</th>
  </tr>
  <tr>
    <td>Sam</td>
    <td>25</td>
  </tr>
</table>
```



PREVIEW

Name	Age
Sam	25

```
<thead> / <tbody>
```

Use to separate a table's header from its body

INDEX.HTML

```
<table>
  <thead><tr><th>Name</th></tr></thead>
  <tbody><tr><td>Sam</td></tr></tbody>
</table>
```



PREVIEW

Name
Sam

06 Forms & Inputs

Everything used to collect information from a visitor.

`<input type="text">`

Use for a single-line text field

INDEX.HTML

```
<input type="text" placeholder="Name">
```



PREVIEW

`<textarea>`

Use for a multi-line text box

INDEX.HTML

```
<textarea>Write here</textarea>
```



PREVIEW

Write here

`<button>`

Use for a clickable button

INDEX.HTML

```
<button>Submit</button>
```



PREVIEW

Submit

<select> / <option>

Use for a dropdown menu



Parent → Child: `<select>` is the container (like `<ul>`). Every choice inside it is a separate `<option>` tag (like `<li>`). The text between `<option>` and `</option>` is what the user sees in the list.

INDEX.HTML

```
<select>
  <option>Red</option>
  <option>Blue</option>
  <option>Green</option>
  <option selected>Yellow</option>
</select>
```



PREVIEW

Yellow

**<label>**

Use to caption a form field

INDEX.HTML

```
<label>Name:</label>
<input>
```



PREVIEW

Name:

<fieldset> / <legend>

Use to group related form fields

📦 **Parent → Child:** `<fieldset>` draws the box around a group of fields. The first thing inside it, `<legend>`, becomes the title printed on the box's border. Any inputs after that sit inside the box.

INDEX.HTML

```
<fieldset>
  <legend>Info</legend>
  <label>Name:</label>
  <input>
</fieldset>
```



PREVIEW

Info

Name:

```
<input type="checkbox"> / <input type="radio">
```

Use for a checkbox or radio choice

INDEX.HTML

```
<input type="checkbox"> Subscribe
<input type="radio"> Yes
```



PREVIEW

☐ Subscribe ☐ Yes

07 Layout & Semantics

Containers that organize a page into meaningful regions.

```
<div>
```

 Use as a generic box for layout

INDEX.HTML

```
<div>Content block</div>
```



PREVIEW

Content block

Use as a generic inline wrapper

INDEX.HTML

Hi ****there****!

PREVIEW

Hi there !

<header>

Use for the page's top banner

INDEX.HTML

<header>My Site**</header>**

PREVIEW

My Site

<nav>

Use for the site's navigation menu

INDEX.HTML

<nav>****Home******</nav>**

PREVIEW

[Home](#) [About](#)**<main>**

Use to mark the page's main content

INDEX.HTML

```
<main>Page content</main>
```



PREVIEW

Page content

```
<section>
```

Use to group a themed chunk of content

INDEX.HTML

```
<section>
  <h2>About</h2>
</section>
```



PREVIEW

About

```
<article>
```

Use for standalone content like a blog post

INDEX.HTML

```
<article>
  <h2>Post Title</h2>
</article>
```



PREVIEW

Post Title

```
<aside>
```

Use for sidebar or related content

INDEX.HTML

```
<aside>Related links</aside>
```



PREVIEW

Related links

<footer>

Use for the page's bottom section

INDEX.HTML

```
<footer>© 2026 My Site</footer>
```



PREVIEW

© 2026 My Site

08 Interactive Extras

A few small tags that add interactivity without any JavaScript.

<details> / <summary>

Use for a click-to-expand section



Parent → Child: `<details>` is the whole collapsible box. The first tag inside it, `<summary>`, is the part that's always visible and clickable. Everything else you write after it stays hidden until the user clicks.

INDEX.HTML

```
<details>
  <summary>More</summary>
  <p>Info here</p>
</details>
```



PREVIEW

► More

<progress>

Use to show task progress

INDEX.HTML

```
<progress value="70" max="100"></progress>
```



PREVIEW

**<meter>**

Use to show a value on a scale

INDEX.HTML

```
<meter value="0.6"></meter>
```



PREVIEW

**<dialog>**

Use for a popup or modal

INDEX.HTML

```
<dialog open>Hello!</dialog>
```



PREVIEW

Hello!

09 Comments

Notes for developers that browsers ignore completely.

<!-- -->

Use to leave a note the browser ignores

INDEX.HTML

```
<!-- This is a note for developers -->
```



PREVIEW

No visual output — invisible to anyone viewing the page.

Quick tips — Most tags come in pairs: `<tag>content</tag>`. A few are self-closing: `br`, `hr`, `img`, `input`, `meta`, `link`. Block elements start a new line; inline elements stay on the current line.